Magic Connect Integration: Customer Q&A

Suggested spoken answers for a Graco customer asking about adding Magic Connect to their existing stroller.

1. Integration

Q: We really like this system. Do you think we could integrate Magic Connect into our existing stroller platform?

A: I think so, yes. But first, we'd need to evaluate which stroller you'd like to integrate it into and see how we could make it work. Most of the changes are around the adapter area, so I think integration should be quite manageable. We'd need to take a closer look at your current design to confirm.

2. Seat redesign

Q: Would we need to redesign the entire seat, or could we keep most of our existing design?

A: Based on our current concept, we should be able to keep most of the existing components. The footrest adjustment mechanism and the backrest adjustment mechanism wouldn't need to change, and the [handle mechanism] could also remain the same. The main modification would likely be to the seat board, but we'd need to review your design to confirm.

3. Tooling and cost

Q: Would this modification affect our existing tooling or increase the manufacturing cost?

A: Since the main modification is to the seat board, I think the impact on your existing tooling could be limited. But we'd need to review your current design to confirm which parts would be affected. As for cost, it would depend on the number of new components and the extent of the tooling changes. Once we've looked at your CAD, we can work out a more accurate estimate.

4. Car seat compatibility

Q: If we integrate Magic Connect into our existing stroller, would it still be compatible with our current car seats?

A: Unfortunately, integrating Magic Connect would affect compatibility with existing car seats. We have two possible approaches to address this.

The first option would be to develop a separate adapter that connects the existing car seat to the Magic Connect system. However, this would reduce some of the benefits of the concept, because parents would still need to align and attach the adapter when installing the car seat.

The second option would be to develop a new car seat system, similar to our MiniBase car seat, that works with Magic Connect.

From a design perspective, I think the second option would provide a better user experience. We would need to evaluate the technical feasibility, but the goal would be to let both the stroller seat and the compatible car seat attach directly to the stroller without a separate adapter. That would make the system simpler and remove the need for parents to handle, or worry about losing, an extra adapter.

5. Follow-up on car seats

Q: Would we need to develop an entirely new car seat, or could we modify our existing car seat to work with Magic Connect?

A: That's something we'd need to look at together. It would depend on the connection structure of your current car seat and its base. One possibility is to modify the existing car seat or its base, but we'd need to review your design before we could say whether that would work.

6. Space and frame

Q: How much space does the mechanism require, and would it fit within our current frame structure?

A: We'd need to check that against your CAD. The main things to look at are the space around the frame tubes, the underside of the seat, the locking pins, the magnets and the operating mechanism. Once we've reviewed those areas, we can tell you how well it fits.

7. Safety and testing

Q: Would we need to conduct additional safety tests, and would this affect the stroller's stability or durability?

A: Probably, yes. Even though the locking mechanism works well in our concept, integrating it into a different stroller means we'd need to review the test requirements for your specific design. We'd evaluate stability and durability as part of that process.

8. Timeline

Q: How long would it take to integrate this into our current platform, and could we do it in our next product update?

A: It depends on how much of the seat and frame needs to change. Once we've reviewed your design, we can estimate the time needed for development, prototyping and validation, and then see whether it fits your next product update.

9. Patents and usage rights

Q: Is Magic Connect patented, and could we use the technology in our own products?

A: I'd need to confirm the current patent status with our team. Whether you could use it in your own products would depend on the patent situation and the terms of our collaboration, so I don't want to promise anything before we've checked.

10. Next steps

Q: What would be the next step if we wanted to adopt this system?

A: A good first step would be to review your current stroller CAD together and confirm the installation space. Then we could identify which parts need to be modified and build an integration prototype to test the concept.